Internal fiction | Greg versus Fred

The forecast was confident. The spreadsheet was fictional.

An entirely fictional internal personnel story

Every personnel event and character action in this deck is invented.
No actual employee, allegation, firing or impairment is described.
Real contract figures appear only as labeled teaching context.

Opening balance | a confidence surplus

He had a number for everything except the source.

- Invented Greg pasted $700m beside 'annual expense.'
- He placed worldwide athlete earnings in a Dodgers revenue column.
- He called the missing U.S. split 'close enough.'

Meet Fred | the new controller checks the units

A new hire with clean arithmetic and a dry sense of humor.

- Fred is the agency's new accountant/controller in this fictional story.
- His talents: source tracing, cash-flow reconciliation and catching a missing valuation date.
- His personality: patient, precise and dryly funny. He asks each number whom it belongs to.
- Real context: $700m nominal; $2m annually in 2024-33; $68m annually in 2034-43.

[MLB1] www.mlb.com

Three ledgers | one paste shortcut

Three recipients. One Greg with a paste shortcut.

- Fred gave the player, club and advertiser separate worksheets.
- Greg objected that three tabs felt bureaucratic.
- Fred replied, 'So does three people sharing one bank account.'

Valuation review | the date matters

Fred found a date. Greg found it inconvenient.

- Real illustration: modeled payment PV is $337.8m at 5%.
- The model date is December 31, 2023, with year-end payments.
- Fictional Greg relabeled it 'cash left today.'
- Fictional Fred restored the date and removed the victory banner.

[FRED_MODEL] finance.json

Termination | the close was final

Greg was fired from the agency. He disputed the ending.

- The agency terminated Greg's employment after repeated refusal to correct his work.
- He arrived at reception, caused a scene and demanded that management 'restate the ending.'
- He left with his mug marked 'Directionally Correct.' The agency kept the stapler.

The next day | an unscheduled arrival

The mailroom had signed up for parcels.

- Greg returned to the agency uninvited and drunk.
- He entered the mailroom and vomited beside the sorter.
- A colleague stopped the equipment; others arranged a safe ride away.
- Greg remained a former employee. The incident ended with a safe exit.

The closeout | correct the accounts

Fred repaired the model. Colleagues preserved Greg's dignity.

- Colleagues helped Greg leave safely after his uninvited return.
- Fred restored source labels, dates and recipient boundaries.
- The agency gave its remaining team a checklist and clear review ownership.
- Greg's termination stood. His worst day did not become office entertainment.

Close the workbook | keep the lesson

The spreadsheet can be repaired without a victory lap.

- Cash timing, payroll accounting and modeled PV answer different questions.
- An announced sponsorship does not disclose its price or incremental profit.
- No real ledger error or personnel misconduct has been established.
- All Greg and Fred dialogue, actions and workplace incidents are invented.

[FRED_MODEL] finance.json

Sources and model limits

[MLB1] MLB: Ohtani contract deferrals explained

www.mlb.com | 2023-12-12

[FRED_MODEL] Fred Cedar: illustrative original-decision payment DCF

finance.json | model valuation date 2023-12-31; prepared 2026-10-13